

SwarmAlpha.

The first open-source **cognitive governance runtime** for LLM multi-agent systems.

Security governance prevents agents from **doing harm**. Cognitive governance prevents agents from **thinking wrong**. The agent governance stack needs both. SwarmAlpha handles the second — detecting echo chambers, authority bias, polarization, and premature consensus during LLM agent collaboration.

THE PROBLEM

- ▶ **Premature consensus** — agreement in round 1; critical info never discussed.
- ▶ **Authority bias** — one overconfident agent dominates the rest.
- ▶ **Echo chamber** — similar agents confirm each other's blind spots.
- ▶ **Group polarization** — divergence hardens into deadlock.
- ▶ **No existing framework** detects or intervenes on these failures.

WHAT WE BUILT

- ▶ **Embeddable governance runtime**, not a framework — drop-in layer for any MAS.
- ▶ **3 value dimensions**: process monitoring, decision audit, adaptive intervention.
- ▶ **LLM perception / Math evolution** separation — agents extract beliefs, math does the rest.
- ▶ **Framework-agnostic SDK** — ~2-4h integration into AutoGen / CrewAI / LangGraph.
- ▶ **13,000+ lines** of TypeScript, 219 automated tests, full open source.

Key Research Contribution — Diagnosing the Governance Loop

We identified **4 root cognitive defects (D1–D4)** in the prevailing MAS discussion paradigm — missing state awareness, no per-agent history, synchronous scripted turns, and fabricated influence networks. All 4 were fixed on 2026-07-12, and the experiments were re-run on Crisis (2026-07-14) with the loop closed — confirming governance effectiveness ($d=0.84$, τ +48%) that prior "governance is ineffective" conclusions had masked.

EXPERIMENTAL EVIDENCE — 89 RUNS ACROSS 2 TASKS (CRISIS 45 + SUPPLIER 44)

Task	Baseline τ	Full Governance τ	Shuffle Control τ	Cohen's d (full vs none)
Crisis (3 rounds, n=15/cell)	0.387 ± 0.160	0.573 ± 0.271	0.760 ± 0.241	+0.84
Supplier (3 rounds, n=15/15/14)	0.680 ± 0.211	0.787 ± 0.177	0.671 ± 0.202	+0.55

✔ **Governance direction consistent** across both tasks — full > none replicates.

✔ **"False consensus" replicates** — consensus-quality $r \approx 0$ in both tasks.

⚠ **Shuffle has boundary conditions** — effective on hard tasks, noise on easy ones.

🔍 **Bayesian reanalysis**: $P(d > 0) = 96.7\%$, 95% HDI [−0.04, 1.13].